

However the future promises a lot more. Aided with superior tactical gear carried by military personnel during an operation, AR can even reveal things that are hidden to the naked eye – enemy movements behind physical objects, type and range of enemy weapons, points of vulnerability in the enemy's defences, simultaneous tracking of multiple enemy personnel – all of which soon prove indispensable to infantry of tomorrow.

Picture is a screenshot from a game. Please crop the more interesting area if needed. Can be used as-is though (text provides grounds for relevance)

Vehicle Windscreens

Gaming is so much of an inspiration for AR that this application has also materialized out of popular games. Being a smart Digit reader, you would have already guessed what genre of games we are talking about: racing.

When you race cars, bikes, trucks, kayaks (basically, anything under the sun) in a game, a lot of information is usually displayed on screen. This may include speed (displayed either on a digital or an analog speedometer), distance from a vehicle, milestone, or random objects in front of you, a map of the path that you are following and visual indications of a sharp turn ahead. Depending on the game, your virtual windscreen may also tell you where cops are waiting for you and whether or not they are following you in a chase. While several developers are working on it, the technology still has to see the light of the day in the real world. One simple application of would be to send a visual alarm as soon as you near or exceed the speed limit.

The innovation and possibilities do not end here. If AR is blended with MANETs (Mobile Ad-Hoc NETWORKs), it can be used to provide drivers with information slow-moving traffic or nearby accidents. On detecting low fuel levels in your gas tank, in addition to alerting you, AR may also visually guide you to the nearest fuel station. Through visual notifications and icons displayed directly on-screen, AR will guide you to your desired destination in a new city, without needing you to calculate the 'next turn according to map' by looking down at an LCD screen.

We are not going to put any pictures but links to two videos:

1. GM testing AR with one of their cars: <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=94dg2D-jAbM>
2. BMW's HUD: <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b4jpuoGP2C8&feature=endscreen>

HUDs

HUDs (Heads Up Displays) are spectacles, windscreens, or other surfaces